

FORENSIC

SCIENCE HYPOTHETICAL

THE KIDNAPPING OF JAMIE LAWSON

JEANNETTE JOLLEY



Quality ready-to-use
resources

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Jeannette Jolley (B.Sc., B.Ed.) is a science teacher at St Clare's College in the Australian Capital Territory. She has over 28 years experience teaching science in three different states. This includes nine years of teaching forensic science as a semester unit. Jeannette was awarded the inaugural ACT Westfield Chief Minister's Scholarship in 2002 for a science teacher to travel overseas to undertake research or a course of study. She used it to complete a Volume Crime Scene Examiner's Course with the UK police at their National Training Centre in County Durham.

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Introduction

The Kidnapping of Jamie Lawson is a practical extended project in which the students are the detectives who must solve the crime. Students will be fascinated throughout this 'real-life' application of the skills and knowledge introduced in Jeannette Jolley's four-book *Forensic Science* series. However, note that solving this crime does not require any previous study or formal knowledge of forensic science.

This book is aimed at middle secondary level; however, it has also been trialled successfully with year 8 students and used as part of non-tertiary senior science units. This hypothetical crime is also useful as practical assessment where forensic science has been taught as a formal assessable unit.

The activities and the extended project in this book could be completed by students at the end of the year or semester as an engaging topic to fill in a gap of several weeks after compulsory work has been finished.

Teacher preparation

Activities 1, 2 and 3 are offered as three single introductory lessons for students who have no formal knowledge or understanding of forensic science. They should be completed before undertaking the solving of the hypothetical crime in the following five lessons (Parts 1 to 5). The sheets can be photocopied and filled in by students.

It is suggested that each part of the hypothetical crime be photocopied on different coloured paper and then stapled together. In this way the sheets can be returned easily to the correct pile at the end of each lesson, ready for redistribution next time. Parts with the finest detail (for example, the fingerprints in Part 4) and the question sheets to be filled in by students should be copied onto white or a pale coloured paper.

As students work through each part, earlier parts should be available so that they can recheck information.

How to prepare the evidence

The following evidence is needed for students to use in **Part 4**.

- Seven small press-seal plastic bags (labelled A, B, C, D, E, F and G – see the table below). These seven bags make up one set of evidence. If your class is large, you may need to make up two or three sets.
- Four different types of wool or synthetic knitting fibres in a dark GREEN colour. (You could use a different colour, but the reference to the green wool would need to be changed on pages 13 and 15.)
- Several magnifying lenses or microscopes. Each set of evidence needs either a microscope or two magnifying lenses with which the students can inspect the samples.
- White and ginger cat fur.

The following table tells you how to compile and label each bag of evidence.

	Evidence	Label
A	Fibres from the first 'wool' sample	Taken from jumper belonging to Alice Lawson
B	Fibres from the second 'wool' sample	Taken from jumper belonging to Brad Lawson
C	Fibres from the third 'wool' sample	Taken from jumper belonging to George Thomas
D	Fibres from the fourth 'wool' sample	Taken from jumper belonging to Frank Furletti
E	Fibres from the third 'wool' sample	Found at crime scene These should be the same fibres as in Bag D, labelled 'Taken from jumper belonging to George Thomas'.
F	Small amount of the white cat fur	Found at crime scene
G	Small amount of the cat fur	Taken from cat owned by Betty and George Thomas Collect ginger and white fur and place both colours in bag G (from George and Betty's cat) and then place only white fur in bag F (crime scene sample). Most students will work out that only white hairs were transferred to the crime scene.

Summary of the hypothetical crime

Part 1: Introduces the crime – a kidnapping (pp.8–9)

This part introduces the crime: Alice Lawson discovers that her two-year-old son, Jamie, is missing from his bed. The police arrive and begin their investigation. Students are asked about what Alice should do and why, then about the police roles and how they may identify some possible suspects.

Teaching suggestions

As this part is fairly short, it is suggested that you organise a class discussion about what students would do if they found themselves as the first person at a crime scene. It is an important safety issue for students of any age to consider what they should do if they arrive home to a burgled house or they witness a crime. If solving the crime is being used as an assessment item, this part can be individual homework.

Part 2: Initial investigation of the crime scene (pp.10–18)

This part introduces the initial evidence found at the crime scene. It also includes Alice's statement to police and maps of the crime scene. Students are asked to explain what should be done with the evidence, to list possible suspects and suggest what questions they would ask the suspects.

Teaching suggestions

In order for students to benefit most from this part, they should first complete Activities 1, 2 and 3 in this book or have some knowledge of how crime scene examiners search a crime scene, how they prepare evidence for transport to a forensic laboratory and what happens to the evidence at the laboratory. Some discussion on the making of casts from impressions and the inspection of hairs and fibres will also be useful. This part works well if students work in pairs or small groups.

Part 3: Statements from the suspects (pp.19–24)

In this part the students read the statements of four different suspects. They then rank these suspects in order of who they think is most likely to be the kidnapper and provide reasons for this order.

Teaching suggestions

In addition to the statements in this part, it is important that all the sheets from previous parts are available for the students to refer to. Like Part 2, this part works well if students work in pairs or small groups. The handwriting samples from Part 2 could be included in this section if there is more time available.

Part 4: More evidence from the suspects and the forensic lab (pp.25–41)

This part provides fingerprints taken from the suspects as well as their shoe prints, tyre prints, samples of their handwriting and actual fur and fibre samples to compare. (Refer to the section on the previous page for instructions on preparing the evidence.)

Students must try to match the evidence with possible suspects and then evaluate whether there is a reasonable explanation for the link, or if the link makes for a stronger case against any of the suspects. They are asked to suggest how they think the crime was carried out and by whom.

Teaching suggestions

To complete this part, students need to have completed Activities 1 and 2 or have some understanding of comparing fingerprints and handwriting. Because there is a lot of evidence to consider, this part could be combined with the previous part in a double lesson, or some evidence such as the handwriting could be considered in Part 3.

Part 5: Final evidence from suspects, police and forensic lab (pp.42–46)

This part provides students with all the information required to work out the complete crime scenario. They can also add to or change any details regarding how they think the crime was carried out, by whom and why.

Teaching suggestions

If used as an assessment item, this part can be done individually under test conditions. Make all the photocopied sheets and evidence available for students to recheck details.

Name _____

Before the twentieth century, it was almost impossible for a criminal to be convicted of a crime unless he or she was 'caught in the act' or identified by an eyewitness. However, in the early 1900s solving crimes started to develop into a science, which involved police closely examining the place where a crime was committed. They looked for clues or evidence that might lead them to discover who committed the crime.

For this to be successful, the crime scene must be as close as possible to the condition it was in when the offender (the person who committed the crime) left. If the scene is interfered with, it is possible that clues or evidence could be destroyed or accidentally carried away by innocent people. Extra evidence that has nothing to do with the crime could also be left behind.

To avoid this, examining the site should be left to experts because they have been trained to look for the smallest pieces of evidence without doing any damage. They look for hairs, fibres, fingerprints invisible to the eye, small spots of blood and more obvious evidence, such as shoeprints or tyre impressions.

These experts wear special protective clothing that does not shed fibres. They stand on duckboards to avoid touching the floor. They also wear hairnets, overshoes and gloves so that they don't leave anything of themselves behind. Small objects are picked up with tweezers and then placed into special bags. These bags are sealed and labelled with the type of object, the date, where the item was found and by whom. This evidence is then transported to the forensic laboratory where it is closely inspected or tested by experienced scientists.

- 1 List five precautions taken by crime scene examiners to ensure that none of their own hairs, fibres or fingerprints are left behind at a crime scene. Explain why you think these precautions are taken.

- 2 What information is written on a bag containing evidence that is collected at a crime scene? Why do you think all this information is necessary?

- 3 In the first column below is a list of forensic experts. In the second column is a list of types of evidence. Draw lines to match each expert with the type of evidence that they would examine.

Forensic dentist	Spots of blood or saliva
Fingerprint expert	Drugs
Handwriting expert	Skeleton of an unknown person
Pathologist or DNA expert	Fingerprints
Chemist or pharmacist	Bullets, gun or used cartridge cases
Ballistics (firearms) expert	Handwritten note

- 4 Imagine that you are the first person to arrive home after school. You find the front door open and the entrance hall has been ransacked. Which one of the following things should you do? Explain why you chose this answer.

- a Run inside and check to see if there was anything missing from your bedroom.
- b Go straight to a neighbour's house to ring your family and the police.
- c Stand in the middle of the footpath and call 'help'.
- d Sit down on the front step and wait for your family to get home.

Name _____

Every person is born with a unique pattern of ridges and furrows on their fingers and hands. These patterns can be used to identify individuals. The ridges and furrows can be grouped into eight basic patterns as shown below.



loop – radial



composite
(mixture of patterns)

Fingerprints cannot be perfectly matched using only these patterns – there must be other characteristics or features that match.

In order to declare that a fingerprint found at a crime scene and a fingerprint held by the police were made by the same finger, a fingerprint expert has to find at least eight identical characteristics on both fingerprints in exactly the same place. Examples of these characteristics are below.



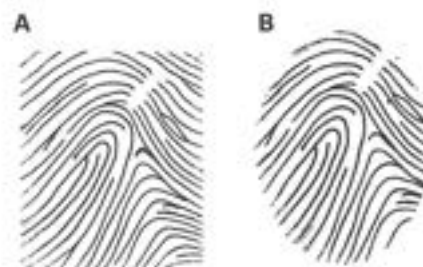
fork



hook

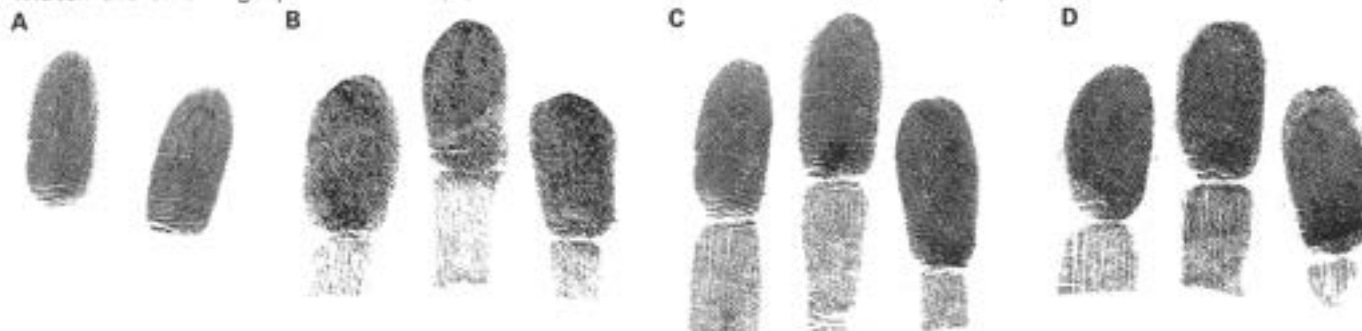
- 1** Find eight characteristics that match in the two fingerprints below right. Classify each characteristic and write the numbers in the appropriate places on the fingerprints.

1	5
2	6
3	7
4	8



- 2** Which fingerprint above do you think was found at a crime scene and which one was made at a police station using ink? Give reasons for your answer.

- 3 Match the two fingerprints below (A) with those taken from three different suspects (B, C and D).



Name _____

An individual's handwriting is unique and the way it appears on paper depends on the interaction of the brain, eye and hand. Its appearance is also affected by the writer's physical and emotional state, the position in which he or she is writing and the type of pen or pencil being used.

The following is a list of things that a handwriting expert would look at when comparing two samples of handwriting:

- How high and low the letters are in relation to a horizontal line
- The average space between the words and some letters
- The pressure and flow of the writing
- The slope of the writing (It can be backhand \\\, normal /// or upright |||.)
- The style of the writing (for example, cursive, printing or block letters)
- The style of certain letters (a or æ, f or f, g or g, t or t)

Experts that analyse handwriting can tell if a person is right-handed (pulls the pen across the page) or left-handed (pushes the pen across the page).

- 1 Look at the following two samples of handwriting. Do you think that they were written by the same person? Give reasons to support your answer.

Meet 7pm at the
corner of Janice St
and Denise Road.
Try not to be late

Monday 17 July
Dear Rose
Thank you very much
for your card. I am
feeling much better.
Jhevon

- 2 The family of Martha Smith are disputing her will saying that it was forged. Compare the handwriting on the will with that taken from Martha's shopping list. Do you think the family is right in having the will checked out? Give reasons for your answer.

My house and all my
worldly goods I leave to
my gardener, Fred Mason.
He has been a good
friend to me and will
look after my dog.

MSmith

Feb 15
Milk fried rice
white bread
butter ham
green beans
tomatoes lettuce
mayonaisse

Name _____

Alice Lawson woke up slowly from a deep sleep. She was surprised when she realised that it was after 8am. She had not slept this late for years. As she lay there she thought about how much their lives were going to change with the exciting news that they received yesterday: Alice and her husband Michael had just won \$1 million in the lottery. She also thought it was strange that Jamie, her active two-and-half-year-old son, had not woken her earlier.

She got up and walked into Jamie's room to check on him before having a shower. Jamie was not there. His cot was empty. Alice was seized by a feeling of deep panic; her breath was sharp and difficult.

'Tamie!' she called out in a choked voice, trying to appear calm. 'Are you downstairs?'

There was no answer. She didn't expect one. Jamie was a rather clingy child and it was not like him to go downstairs on his own. His usual routine, now that he could climb out of the cot, was to creep into his mother's bed once his father had left for work. They would exchange some hugs and kisses then Jamie would demand his breakfast.

Still, Alice ran downstairs. No sign of Jamie there. Her husband Michael, Jamie's father, was away interstate for work and was not expected to return until later that day. Alice was really scared now. She turned and ran back up the stairs. Just one more look in Jamie's room to make sure she hadn't made a mistake. This time as she walked into the room she noticed an envelope sitting on a toy shelf. It was propped up against one of Jamie's bears. She lunged for it and tore it open.

It said:

We have your baby. He will be or right if you don't go to the police.

Get \$10,000 in cash and wait for our call.

- 1 What are the first two things that you think Alice should do, and in what order? What is one thing that Alice should NOT do?

- 2** Give reasons for your answer to question 1.

Name _____

Imagine that you are the person in charge of the investigation into the disappearance of Jamie Lawson.

- 3 Listed in the table below are three key people who might be at the crime scene to help you with the investigation. For each person, describe what tasks you think he or she would be expected to carry out at the crime scene. Use the description to guess who the fourth person is.

Key people needed at a crime scene	Description of each person's tasks
Crime scene examiner/s	
Psychological profiler	
Police draftsman	
	<i>To photograph the scene before anything is moved</i>

- 4 In the list below, highlight the first two tasks that you, as the person in charge, would carry out.
- Search for possible evidence at the Lawson's house.
 - Question the neighbours regarding anything suspicious they have seen.
 - Interview Mrs Lawson to find out who she thinks might have kidnapped her son.
 - Analyse the ransom note.
 - Organise and supervise all the different people who are helping to find Jamie.

- 5 Who will check the ransom note?

- 6 What are two important things that the person checking the ransom note might look for?

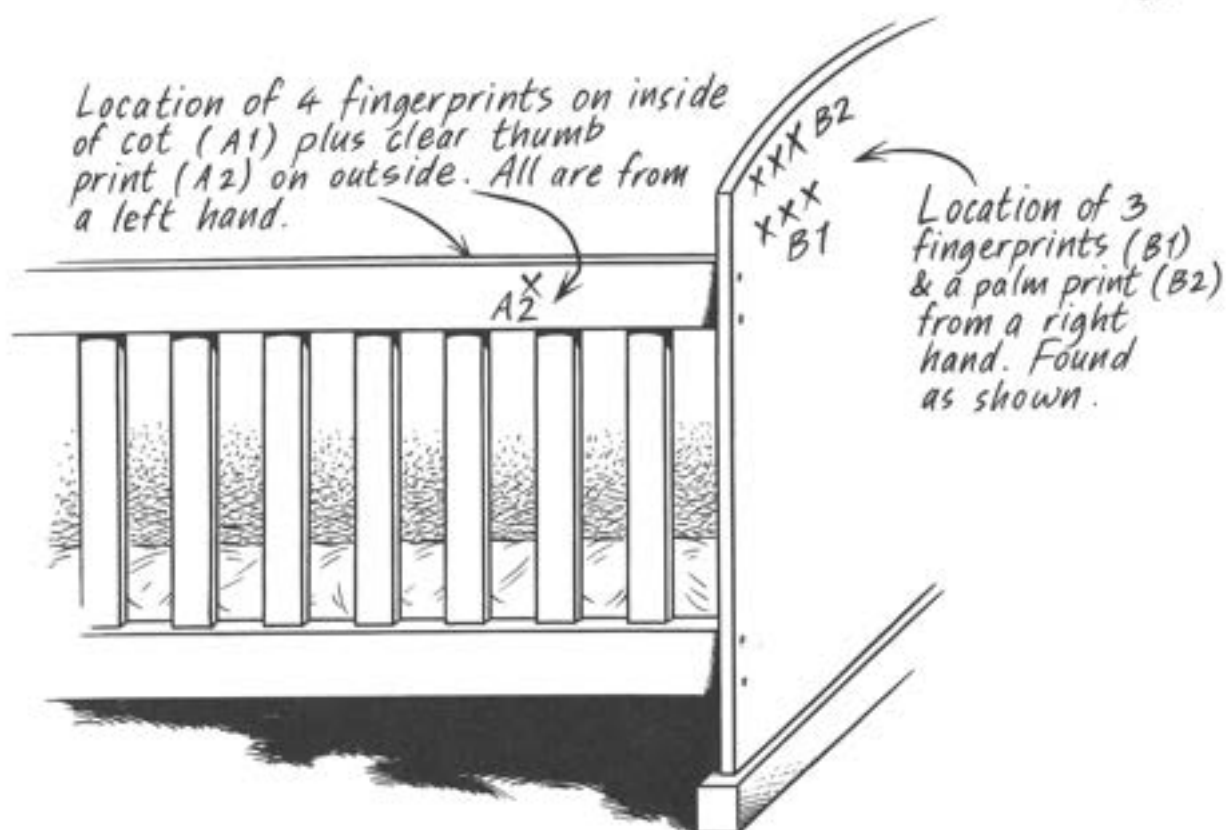
- 7 List five different types of evidence that you would instruct your staff to look for at the Lawson's house.

- 8 What are four important questions Alice Lawson should be asked?

- 9 What are two things you can do to help start a list of suspects?

Evidence collected by mid-morning

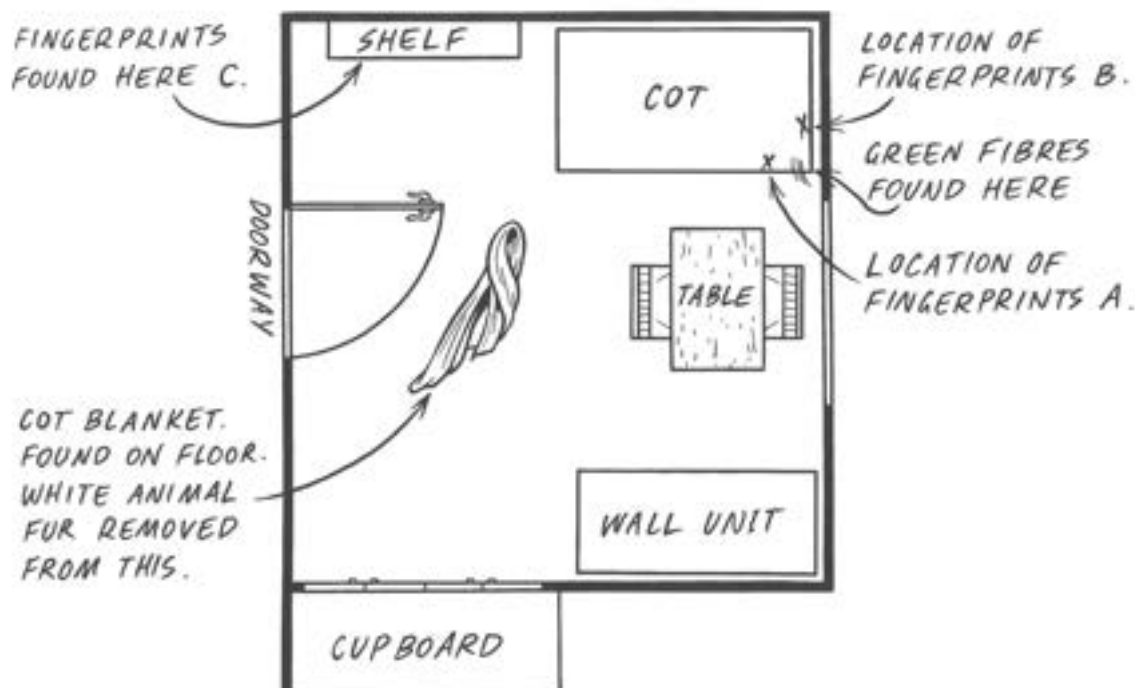
a Two sets of fingerprints were found on the cot in Jamie's room.



b A different set of fingerprints was found on the shelf in Jamie's room. The diagram below shows where the fingerprints and the other evidence were found in the bedroom.



Location of 3 fingerprints (c1) and a part palm print (c2) of a right hand on shelf.

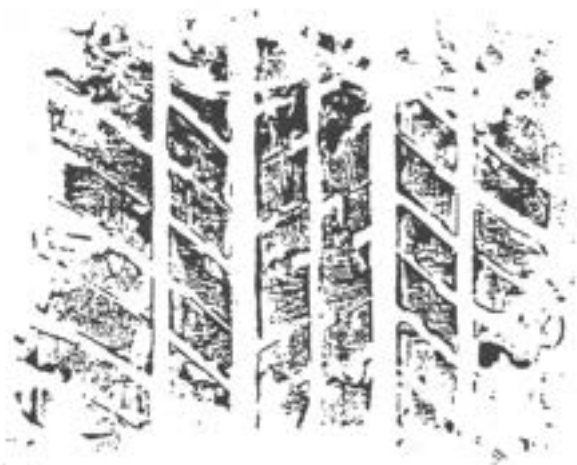


Part 2 cont'd

c The tyre marks below were found in the laneway by the side fence of the house (see A below) and two different sets in the driveway (see B and C). The locations of these impressions are shown on the map on page 14.



A
By side fence (Bell Rd)
12 Nerine Drive,
Smithton

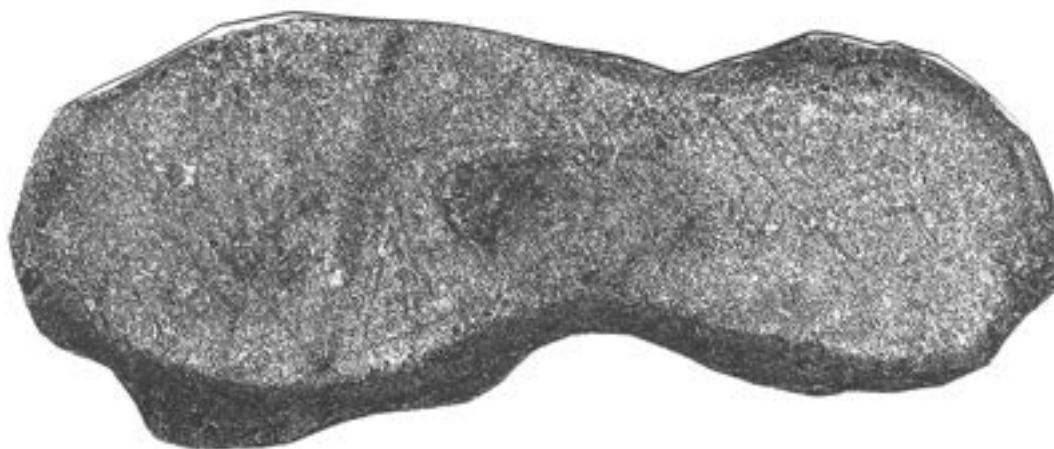


B
Driveway, 12 Nerine Drive, Smithton



C
Driveway, 12 Nerine Drive, Smithton

d Footprints were found in a garden bed outside the downstairs dining room window. A plaster cast was made by the crime scene examiners. It was estimated that the footprints were made by a size 11 sports (jogging) shoe. See the photograph of the cast below. The location of these footprints is shown on the map on page 14.



e A dirty squashed cigarette butt was found on the floor in Jamie's room, just beside the cot.

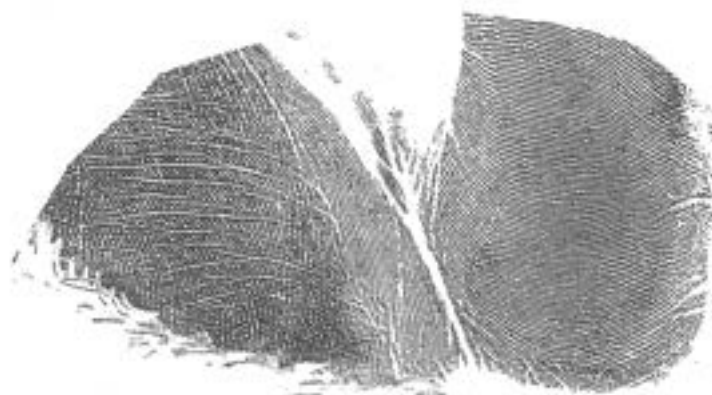
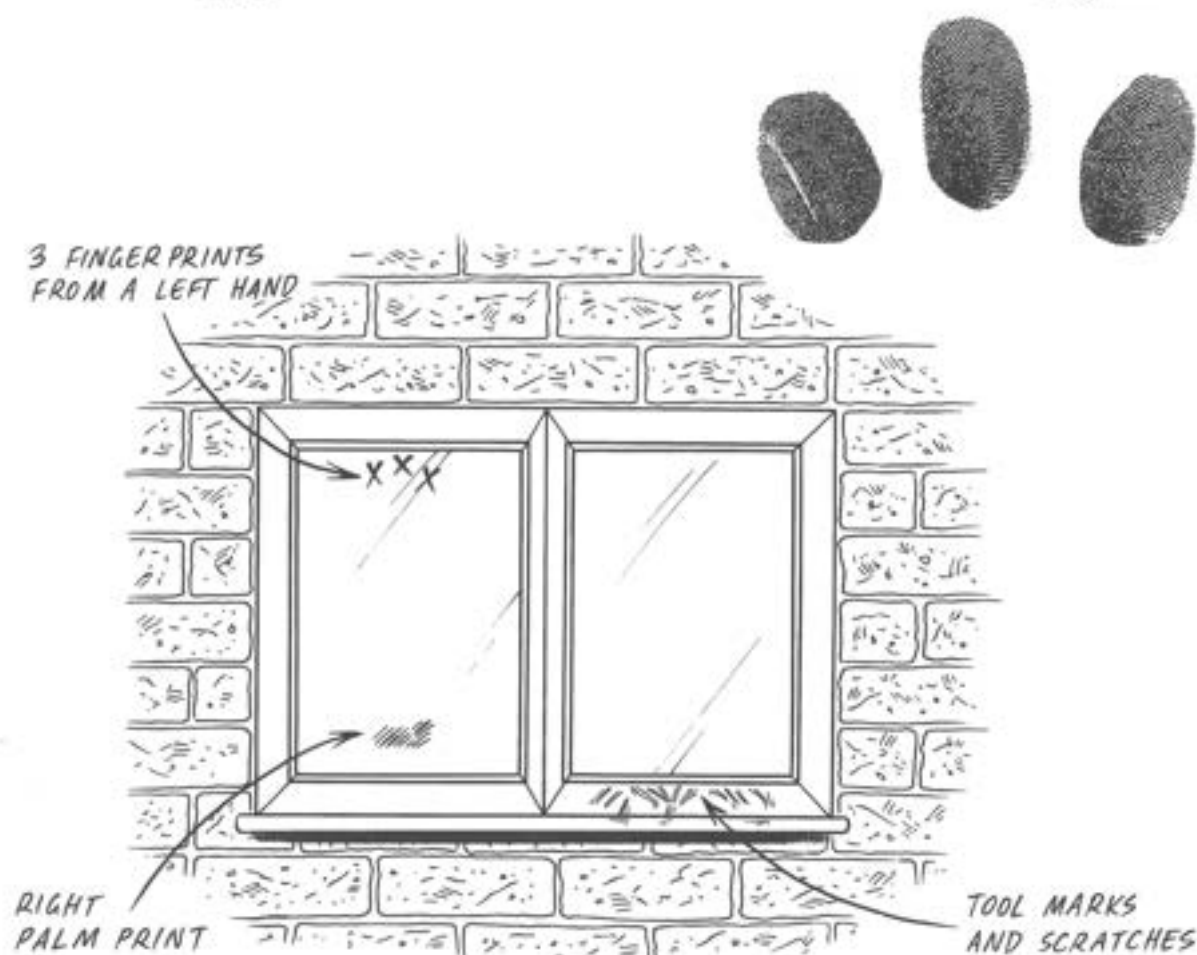


f An unfinished cup of tea was found on a coffee table in the family room near the TV.

g There were some long green fibres caught in the rail of the cot where the wooden slats meet the horizontal rail.

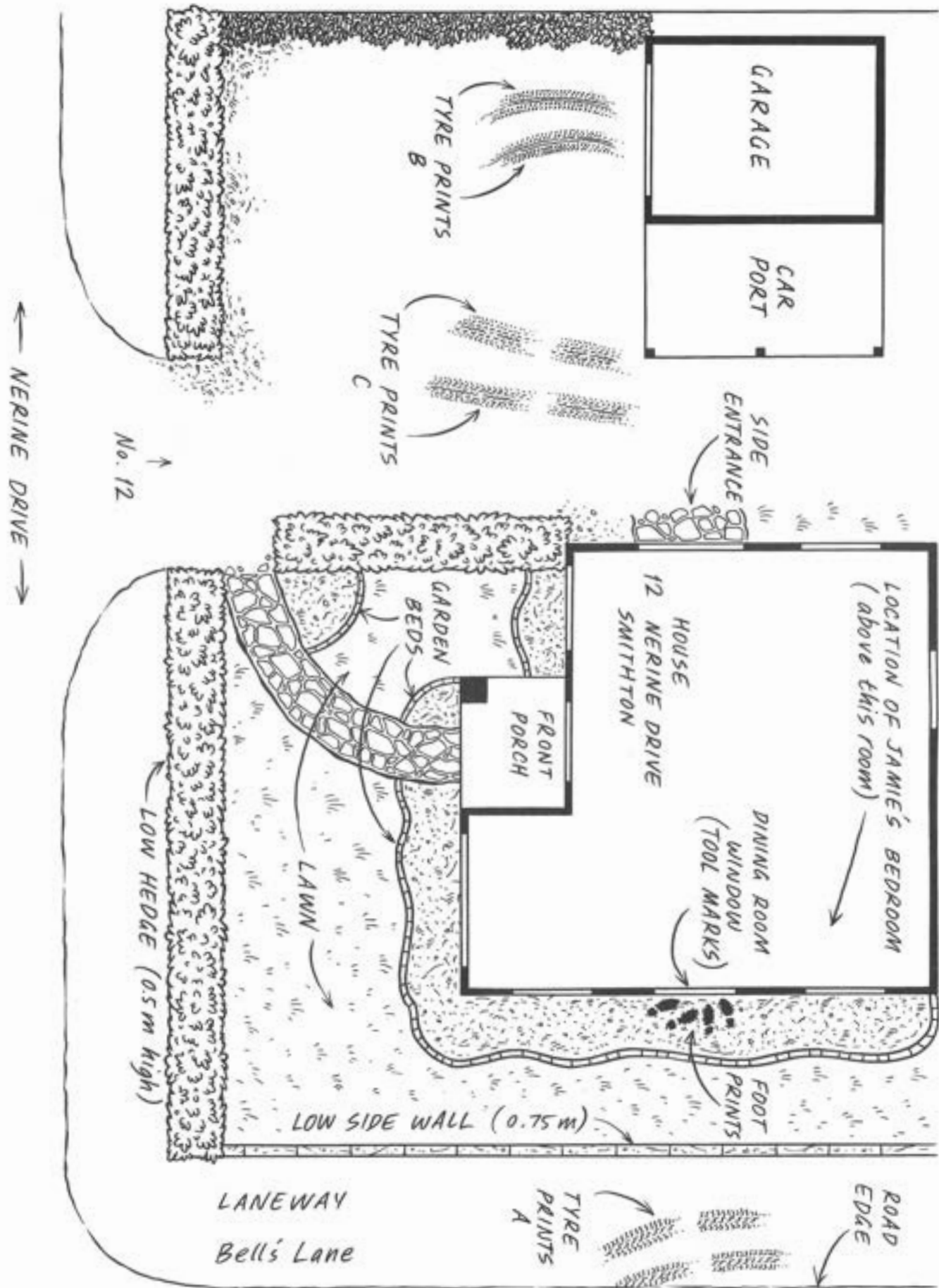
h There was a small number of white animal hairs found on the cot blanket when it was vacuumed.

i Tool marks (possibly from a tyre lever or screwdriver) were found on a downstairs dining room window. There was evidence of scratches on the windowsill, consistent with someone having climbed through the window. However, the window was locked when inspected by the police. The diagram below shows where tool marks and fingerprints were found. The location of this window is shown on page 14.



Map of house and yard

12 Nerine Drive, Smithton



POLICE CONSTABULARY STATEMENT OF WITNESS



Statement of (name of witness) Alice Lawson

Taken by D. I. Brown Date 18.6.10 Time 9.00am

Q Mrs Lawson, could you give your full name, age, address, spouse and relationship to the missing boy for the benefit of the tape please.

I am Alice Louise Lawson; aged 30 years; and I live at 12 Nerine Drive, Smithton. I am married to Michael Trevor Lawson and we have one son James Michael Lawson, aged two-and-a-half years.

Q Mrs Lawson, could you tell me about your movements yesterday?

I was woken as usual at about 6am by Jamie. Michael my husband got up immediately because he had to leave at 7am to catch a plane. Betty, my housekeeper, arrived about 9am as she was taking Saturday off to spend the weekend with her sister. Normally she comes in at 10am.

I went out at about 11am to do some shopping and meet a friend for lunch. Jamie was with me all day. I returned about 2pm, and I put Jamie down for a nap.

About 2.30pm, the plumber arrived to fix a dripping tap and check on a sink that was draining very slowly. He was here for about an hour, I think.

At 3.05pm the phone rang. I know the time because I was worried that the noise might wake Jamie up, and I noted he had only been down about an hour. The phone call was from a person in the lottery syndicate we belong to telling us that we had won \$1 million – a share in the first division prize.

Q Were both the plumber and your housekeeper in the house when you received that telephone call? Would they have known about the win?

Yes, both were here. I don't know if the plumber knew what the phone call was about but I was a bit excited when I first heard. Betty knows about the money because she came in to see what was wrong when I screamed. I told her about the money and asked her not to tell anyone.

Q Is there anyone else who knows that you won this money?

Yes. As soon as I hung up the phone I tried to call my husband. He was in a meeting so I left a message for him to ring me back. His call came through after 5pm; in fact, I think it might have been nearer to 5.30. We agreed not to tell anyone else until he got home and we talked about what we would do.

There are two other people who know about us winning the money. I was so excited and needed to talk to someone. When I couldn't reach Michael, I waited for the plumber to finish then took Jamie next door to my friend Jenny Phillips. We had a coffee and chatted about all the things we could do with the money. I left about 4.30pm because I didn't want to miss Michael's call. I left Jamie to play with Jenny's little boy Adam and she brought him home at about quarter to six.

The other person who knows is Michael's youngest brother Brad. He turned up at our house about 5 o'clock. We haven't seen him for four years. He's been overseas you see, travelling around. He's sort of the black sheep of the family, no regular job, just moving from place to place. He was hoping to catch up with Michael but I told him that he would have to wait until tonight. It was while he was here that Michael rang back, so Brad heard about the money then too. We asked him not to tell the rest of the family until Michael got home – and now this has happened. Who would do such a thing? He's only a little boy, he must be terrified! I hope wherever he is he's all right. Please, hurry up and find him!

Q It's okay Mrs Lawson; I have a large team of experienced officers out there combing the area for every clue. I'm sure we'll find out who's responsible very soon. What you have to do is tell me everything that you know so we don't overlook a single detail. You never know when something that seems unimportant turns out to be the very thing that points to the person we're after. Now before we finish, I want you to tell me what you did after your husband's phone call.

We didn't talk long as Michael had to get ready to go to dinner. Brad left very soon after. When Jenny brought Jamie back, I gave him his bath and we had tea about 6 o'clock or just after. I read Jamie a few stories before tucking him in to bed just before seven. I am sure about that time, because I wanted to catch the 7 o'clock news on television. Betty brought me in a cup of tea just before the news finished and she must have left not long after that. I must have been very tired because I don't remember her leaving or what I watched after the news. I thought that the excitement of the money must have made me tired, I woke up in front of the TV at about 11pm. Then I went up to bed and fell asleep again straight away.

Q Mrs Lawson, do any other people besides you and your husband have keys to your house?

Yes, of course. Betty has a key and so does Jenny. We also left a key hidden outside last week for the plumber who was here to do some other work. That key is now back in the drawer in the kitchen.

Q I see. Now I want you to think very carefully. Do you remember hearing any noises in the night or anything else that was strange?

No. I recall feeling tired and I only vaguely remember going up to bed. I slept like a log all night until about 8am.

Q Mrs Lawson, do you or your husband smoke?

No, neither of us smoke.

Q Also I must ask you, do you own any pets?

No, we don't have any animals here.

Q One last question please Mrs Lawson. Can you describe exactly what your son was wearing when you put him to bed? Also, we'd like a photograph of Jamie that we can circulate.

Jamie was wearing a pale blue all-in-one suit with a zipper down the middle. It had a dark blue collar and cuffs. Here's a photo for you – we took it at the beach a few weeks ago.

D.I. Thank you Mrs Lawson. We will let you know as soon as we hear anything. Now I want you to stay here close to the phone in case the kidnapper rings. There will be a police officer listening too. We'll tape and trace any calls that come in.

This statement of 2 pages signed by me is the truth to the best of my knowledge.

Dated the 18th day of June 20 10 Signed Al Lawson

Name _____

- 1 In the first column in the table below is a list of the evidence found at the crime scene. In the second column, explain how you think the experts found this evidence and then how they removed and transported it to a forensic lab. In the third column, describe the tests that you think would be carried out on the evidence in a laboratory. The first one has been done for you.

Evidence	How the evidence is found and removed	Tests carried out in laboratory
a Fingerprints found on the cot and on the shelf in Jamie's room	<i>Dusted with fingerprint powder Photographed and then lifted with sticky tape</i>	<i>Compared with suspect prints and any on file</i>
b Tyre marks found in driveway and near the side fence		
c Footprints found outside the dining room window		
d Squashed cigarette butt found in Jamie's room		
e Unfinished cup of tea		
f Green fibres caught on the cot		
g White animal fur found on the cot blanket		
h Tool marks found on the dining room window		
i Ransom note		

Part 2 cont'd



Name _____

2 Referring to the evidence that was found at the scene, give each person listed in the table below a score out of 10 according to how likely it is that they are the kidnapper (in the second column). For example, give a score of 10 to the person (or people) you think might be guilty of the crime. In the last column give reasons for your scores, including motives.

Person	Score	Reasons
Alice Lawson (mother)		
Michael Lawson (father)		
Betty Thomas (housekeeper)		
Frank Furletti (plumber)		
Jenny Phillips (friend)		
Brad Lawson (Michael's brother)		

3 Write at least six questions that you would ask all of the suspects.

POLICE CONSTABULARY STATEMENT OF WITNESS



Statement of (name of witness) Elizabeth Thomas

Taken by D.C. McDonald Date 18.6.10 Time 10.00am

Q Mrs Thomas, could you give your full name, age, address, spouse's name and relationship to the Lawson's for the benefit of the tape please.

My name is Elizabeth Catherine Thomas but I'm always called Betty. I am 48 years of age, married to George Albert Thomas and we have no children. We live in Unit 15, 238 Foster Road, Smithton. I am employed by Mrs Lawson as a housekeeper.

Q Mrs Thomas, I want you to tell me what happened yesterday, starting at about the time Mrs Lawson came home from shopping after lunch.

Yes, well Mrs Lawson got in about two-ish and put the little boy to bed. Not long after, the plumber arrived to fix the drain. Mrs Lawson got a phone call about three when I was doing the vegies for tea. I heard her scream – I thought something bad might have happened to Mr Lawson, but it turns out that they won a million dollars. I wish it'd happened to us. Here's George and me, actually needing the money now that George can't even get a job since he was laid off two years ago. I guess life's just not fair.

Q Yes, I see Mrs Thomas. Now what happened after the phone call?

Well, Mrs Lawson tries to ring her hubby but he's still in a meeting. She waited until the plumber was finished then took the little one and went next door to tell Mrs Phillips about her good luck. She was only gone about an hour and when she got back she had a visitor – some hippie type who turns out to be Mr Lawson's young brother. Well they seem like chalk and cheese to me; it's hard to believe they come from the same family.

Q About what time do you think Mrs Lawson's brother-in-law arrived?

It must have been just before five, because I was on the phone to my hubby when the doorbell rang. I was glad that Mrs Lawson answered it and I could finish talking to my hubby.

Q Mrs Thomas, did you tell your husband about the Lawson's good fortune?

Ah. Well yes, I did mention it on the phone. Mrs Lawson didn't exactly tell me not to. Anyway, husbands and wives shouldn't have secrets from each other, don't you think?

Q Well, I don't know if you could call it keeping a secret from him, but tell me what happened after the doorbell rang.

Well I asked Mrs Lawson if they wanted any tea or coffee, but they both said no. Then I remembered that I hadn't rung the carpenter who was supposed to fix the dining room window, the one Mr Lawson nearly wrecked a few nights ago. Silly man, went out jogging and locked himself out and then had to break in through the window. After I made the phone call, I went back to getting dinner ready. I think the young man left after Mr Lawson rang, maybe around half past five.

Q Mrs Thomas, can you tell me when Mr Michael Lawson rang?

Not the exact time, but between five and five thirty. Probably nearer five thirty, I'd say.

Q Good. Now after Mr Brad Lawson left, can you tell me what happened?

Yes. First Mrs Phillips from next door brought Jamie home, then Mrs Lawson bathed him and they had tea about 6 o'clock. That's the time Mrs Lawson always likes it. After tea, she went upstairs and put Jamie to bed. I made her a cup of tea after seven when she was watching the news.

Q What did you do after you made the cup of tea for Mrs Lawson? Did you leave then?

While she was watching the news I stacked the dishwasher and cleared up. I was finished just before eight. I went to say goodbye, but Mrs Lawson was asleep in front of the TV. She must have been very tired 'cos she didn't reply when I said I was going.

Q So you left at about 8 o'clock then?

Yes, that's right.

Q Mrs Thomas, do either you or your husband smoke?

No, we don't smoke. We can't afford it. I made George give up smoking about 10 years ago.

Q Just a couple of last questions please Mrs Thomas. Do you have any pets?

Well yes, but I don't see what that's got to do with the boy being kidnapped.

Q No, but could you please just answer the question. What sort of animal or animals do you have, Mrs Thomas?

We have two. A little fox terrier that's been the only bright thing in my husband's life since he lost his job, and Molly the cat is mine.

Q What colours are these animals please?

The dog is black and white and the cat is ginger and white.

Q One last question. Mrs Thomas, do you have a key to the Lawson's house?

Yes of course. I work there six days a week, so I drive myself there at 10am most days and let myself in. If Mrs Lawson isn't home, I lock up when I go. Yesterday I worked later so that I could have today off to stay with my sister for the whole weekend.

D.C. Well thank you Mrs Thomas. We really do appreciate your coming back to help us with our enquiries. We'll be in touch if we have any further questions.

This statement of 2 pages signed by me is the truth to the best of my knowledge.

Dated the 18th day of June 20 10 Signed JC Thomas

POLICE CONSTABULARY
STATEMENT OF WITNESS



Statement of (name of witness) Frank Furletti

Taken by D. C. Collins Date 18.6.10 Time 11.00am

Q Mr Furletti, could you give your full name, age, address, spouse's name and relationship to the Lawsons for the benefit of the tape please.

I am Frank Furletti. I live at 23 Livingstone Street, Smithton, am 55 years of age and married to Luisa Furletti. I was doing some plumbing at the Lawson's house from 2.30 to 3.30pm yesterday.

Q Thank you for coming in Mr Furletti. Will you please answer a few questions about what you saw when you were at the Lawson house? Firstly, what were you actually doing there?

I was fixing a blocked drain. Some people think that all the scraps can be washed down the drain and then they wonder why the sink doesn't empty! I also changed the washer on a laundry tap.

Q When you arrived, did you see the little boy Jamie?

No, he wasn't around. He must have been asleep because Mrs Lawson asked me not make any noise. But then I heard her scream on the phone, so I don't know why she asked me to be quiet.

Q So Mr Furletti, you heard that Mrs Lawson won a lot of money yesterday?

No, I heard that today. Yesterday I thought she had won a raffle. I didn't realise it was so much money. At least she won't be able to say that she can't afford to pay me!

Q Yes, well that is true. Now you say you left the house at 3.30pm?

Yes, I stopped around the corner on the nature strip in the side street after I left the house. I wrote down the time so I could work out how long I spent on the job. I wrote out an account and then walked back and put it in the letterbox.

Q Now, can you tell me what you did last night Mr Furletti?

After I left Mrs Lawson's place, I went straight home to look after my wife. She's very ill, you know. She can hardly walk, and is waiting to get into hospital to have a hip replacement. She is in a lot of pain, but because we haven't got private health cover we have to wait a long time. Even part of a million dollars would get my wife in straight away. They are very lucky people, the Lawsons.

Q It must be hard to see people who are already comfortably off win more money while you and your wife need it so badly. Would you try a little harmless kidnapping to encourage the Lawsons to share some of their money with you to help your wife?

Definitely not. I love children and always look forward to seeing our grandchildren. I think that anyone who does something like that should be put in jail.

Q Mr Furletti, do you have any pets?

Yes, my wife and I have a white Samoyed dog; here I'll show you a picture of her.

Q Yes, I can see, a very well looked after animal. It must take some time to brush that long hair. Now just one last question Mr Furletti. Do you smoke, and if you do, what brand?

Yes, I do smoke. I usually buy Stradbroke cigarettes but I don't smoke while I'm working.

D.C. Thank you very much Mr Furletti, we appreciate your giving up your time. We'll be in touch if we need to ask you any further questions. Meanwhile please do not leave Smithton without checking with us first.

This statement of 1 pages signed by me is the truth to the best of my knowledge.

Dated the 18th day of June 20 10 Signed Frank Furletti

POLICE CONSTABULARY
STATEMENT OF WITNESSStatement of (name of witness) Jennifer PhillipsTaken by D. C. McDonald Date 18.6.10 Time 11.00am

Q Mrs Phillips, could you give your full name, age, address, spouse's name and relationship to the Lawsons for the benefit of the tape please.

My name is Jennifer Anne Phillips, I live at 14 Nerine Drive, Smithton. I am 34 years of age, am married to Andrew Peter Phillips and have two children, Megan aged 5 years and Adam aged 3.

Q Thank you Mrs Phillips. Now can you please tell us all the times you saw either Mrs Lawson or Jamie Lawson yesterday?

Yes, of course. Alice came around with Jamie about three thirty yesterday afternoon. I am quite confident of the time because I had just returned from picking up my daughter Megan from school. We had a cup of coffee together and Jamie played with my son Adam.

Q Right, so Mrs Lawson and Jamie arrived at 3.30pm. Did Mrs Lawson have something special to tell you?

I am sure she has already told you. She came over, very excited, to share her good fortune with me.

Q Mrs Phillips, did you at any time tell anyone else about the Lawsons winning the money?

Yes, I told my husband when he came home at 5 o'clock. I asked Alice if it was okay first. I have told no one else.

Q When did Mrs Lawson go home after visiting you?

Alice didn't stay long because she wanted to be able to tell Michael when he rang. The boys were playing so nicely that we agreed to leave Jamie here for a while. He is a lovely child although sometimes he has some strange habits. The other day he was collecting all sorts of rubbish; a stone, a piece of glass, even a cigarette butt, all went into his pockets! However, he and Adam play well together. I took him home at about quarter to six.

Q And that was the last time you saw Jamie?

Yes. It's so awful. Alice must be terribly worried. Would it be all right for me to go over to help her in some way?

Q Yes, I am sure that would be okay. My officers should be finished there now. Just before you go, just a couple more questions. Firstly, do either you or your husband smoke?

No, neither of us smokes. That would be silly, having young children, wouldn't it?

Q Mrs Phillips, do you have any pets?

Yes. We have Fluff, our white rabbit, the children all adore him. And Duke our German Shepherd.

D.C. Thank you for your time Mrs Phillips, you have been most helpful.

This statement of 1 pages signed by me is the truth to the best of my knowledge.

Dated the 18th day of June 20 10 Signed J Phillips

POLICE CONSTABULARY
STATEMENT OF WITNESSStatement of (name of witness) Bradley LawsonTaken by D. C. Collins Date 18.6.10 Time 12.30pm

Q Mr Lawson, could you give your full name, age, address, spouse's name and relationship to the Lawsons for the benefit of the tape please.

My name is Bradley John Lawson. I am 30 years old and at present am staying in the Ozone Guest House on Brighton Boulevard. I have just returned from four years overseas. I am single and am Michael Lawson's youngest brother.

Q Thank you for coming in Mr Lawson. We would just like to ask you a few questions as you may have been one of the last people to see your nephew Jamie.

Well, I never actually saw Jamie. In fact, I have never seen Jamie because he was born after I left to go to Thailand. Of course I've seen photos of him, but yesterday when I called Alice said that he was playing at a neighbour's house.

Q Yes, that could well have been the case. Now about what time did you arrive at your brother's house and why did you come?

Why I went there must be obvious – I haven't seen my brother Michael for four years, I called hoping to see him. Alice seemed a bit preoccupied and not all that welcoming, as if I was interrupting something, so I didn't stay long. I arrived about 5 o'clock and left about five thirty. I had hoped to get a meal, but with Michael away I thought I'd better get back to my hotel and get dinner there.

Q Thank you Mr Lawson. Now while you were at your brother's house, your sister-in-law received a phone call from your brother, didn't she?

Yes, that's right. Alice answered the phone and she was so excited about the money, she didn't even tell Michael that I was there. I felt quite hurt.

Q So Mr Lawson, you knew about the money last night then?

Yes, I could hardly avoid knowing, could I? With all her blabbing and gushing. I had some very special news of my own to tell. I suppose it will have to wait now. Hey! You don't think that I took the kid do you? I might have a good use for even a tenth of that money, but Michael is my brother and I am not a criminal.

Q We are not suggesting anything of the sort at the moment. We have just one last question. Do you smoke Mr Lawson, and if so what?

Well yes, I do sometimes, occasionally I carry tobacco and roll my own. But not regularly, as a general rule.

D.C. Thank you for coming in. Please do not go back overseas without checking with us first.

This statement of 1 pages signed by me is the truth to the best of my knowledge.

Dated the 18th day of June 20 10 Signed Bradley Lawson

Part 3 cont'd

Name _____

- 1 In the first column in the table below is a list of the suspects. In the second column, record information that could point to the possible guilt of that person based on what you have read in his or her statement. In the third column, record information that points to the possible innocence of that person. (If you need more space, use the back of this sheet.)

Suspect	Information from the statement that points to possible guilt	Information from the statement that points to possible innocence
Alice Lawson		
Betty Thomas		
Frank Furletti		
Jennifer Phillips		
Brad Lawson		

- 2 Think of two **other** people that you would like to interview. List each person in the first column of the table below. In the second column, write the reason why you would like to interview him or her. In the third column, write at least three questions that you would ask each person. (If you need more space, use the back of this sheet.)

Suspect	The reason why you would like to interview him or her	Three questions you would ask

ELIMINATION FINGERPRINT FORM

This form must be completed in BLOCK LETTERS using black ink.

Palm prints should be taken overleaf.

TO BE USED FOR TAKING PRINTS OF VICTIMS OF CRIME, SUSPECTS AND THOSE WITH LEGITIMATE ACCESS TO A CRIME SCENE.

Name ALICE LAWSON Taken by MATTHEWS
 Address 12 NERINE DRIVE, SMITHTON Rank D.I.
 Offence KIDNAP Date 18.6.10
 Location 12 NERINE DRIVE, SMITHTON Crime Reference Number 921176

These prints will be destroyed after the necessary comparisons have been made unless the donor has been found guilty of the crime.

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF RIGHT HAND

1 Right Thumb	2 Right Fore	3 Right Middle	4 Right Ring	5 Right Little
				

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF LEFT HAND

6 Left Thumb	7 Left Fore	8 Left Middle	9 Left Ring	10 Left Little
				

PLAIN IMPRESSION OF BOTH HANDS

LEFT HAND Four fingers taken together	TWO THUMBS Taken together LEFT RIGHT	RIGHT HAND Four fingers taken together
		

Part 4 cont'd

ALICE LAWSON
Right Hand



Left Hand



ELIMINATION FINGERPRINT FORM

This form must be completed in BLOCK LETTERS using black ink.

Palm prints should be taken overleaf.

TO BE USED FOR TAKING PRINTS OF VICTIMS OF CRIME, SUSPECTS AND THOSE WITH LEGITIMATE ACCESS TO A CRIME SCENE.

Name ELIZABETH THOMAS Taken by BROWNHILL
 Address 15/238 FOSTER ROAD, SMITHTON Rank D.S.
 Offence KIDNAP Date 18.6.10
 Location 12 NERINE DRIVE, SMITHTON Crime Reference Number 921176

These prints will be destroyed after the necessary comparisons have been made unless the donor has been found guilty of the crime.

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF RIGHT HAND

1 Right Thumb	2 Right Fore	3 Right Middle	4 Right Ring	5 Right Little
				

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF LEFT HAND

6 Left Thumb	7 Left Fore	8 Left Middle	9 Left Ring	10 Left Little
				

PLAIN IMPRESSION OF BOTH HANDS

LEFT HAND Four fingers taken together	TWO THUMBS Taken together LEFT RIGHT	RIGHT HAND Four fingers taken together
		

Part 4 cont'd

ELIZABETH THOMAS

Right Hand



Left Hand



ELIMINATION FINGERPRINT FORM

This form must be completed in BLOCK LETTERS using black ink.

Palm prints should be taken overleaf.

TO BE USED FOR TAKING PRINTS OF VICTIMS OF CRIME, SUSPECTS AND THOSE WITH LEGITIMATE ACCESS TO A CRIME SCENE.

Name BRADLEY LAWSON Taken by MATTHEWS
 Address C/O P.O. 1743 SYDNEY Rank D.I.
 Offence KIDNAP Date 18.6.10
 Location 12 NERINE DRIVE, SMITHTON Crime Reference Number 921176

These prints will be destroyed after the necessary comparisons have been made unless the donor has been found guilty of the crime.

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF RIGHT HAND

1 Right Thumb	2 Right Fore	3 Right Middle	4 Right Ring	5 Right Little
				

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF LEFT HAND

6 Left Thumb	7 Left Fore	8 Left Middle	9 Left Ring	10 Left Little
				

PLAIN IMPRESSION OF BOTH HANDS

LEFT HAND Four fingers taken together	TWO THUMBS Taken together LEFT RIGHT	RIGHT HAND Four fingers taken together
		

Part 4 cont'd

BRADLEY LAWSON
Right Hand



Left Hand



ELIMINATION FINGERPRINT FORM

This form must be completed in BLOCK LETTERS using black ink.

Palm prints should be taken overleaf.

TO BE USED FOR TAKING PRINTS OF VICTIMS OF CRIME, SUSPECTS AND THOSE WITH LEGITIMATE ACCESS TO A CRIME SCENE.

Name FRANK FURLETTI Taken by PATTERSON

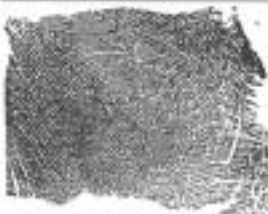
Address 23 LIVINGSTONE STREET, SMITHTON Rank D.C.

Offence KIDNAP Date 18.6.10

Location 12 NERINE DRIVE, SMITHTON Crime Reference Number 921176

These prints will be destroyed after the necessary comparisons have been made unless the donor has been found guilty of the crime.

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF RIGHT HAND

1 Right Thumb	2 Right Fore	3 Right Middle	4 Right Ring	5 Right Little
				

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF LEFT HAND

6 Left Thumb	7 Left Fore	8 Left Middle	9 Left Ring	10 Left Little
				

PLAIN IMPRESSION OF BOTH HANDS

LEFT HAND Four fingers taken together	TWO THUMBS Taken together LEFT RIGHT	RIGHT HAND Four fingers taken together
		

Part 4 cont'd

FRANK FURLETTI
Right Hand



Left Hand



ELIMINATION FINGERPRINT FORM

This form must be completed in BLOCK LETTERS using black ink.

Palm prints should be taken overleaf.

TO BE USED FOR TAKING PRINTS OF VICTIMS OF CRIME, SUSPECTS AND THOSE WITH LEGITIMATE ACCESS TO A CRIME SCENE.

Name GEORGE THOMAS Taken by PATTERSON
 Address 15/238 FOSTER ROAD, SMITHTON Rank D.C.
 Offence KIDNAP Date 18.6.10
 Location 12 NERINE DRIVE, SMITHTON Crime Reference Number 921176

These prints will be destroyed after the necessary comparisons have been made unless the donor has been found guilty of the crime.

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF RIGHT HAND

1 Right Thumb	2 Right Fore	3 Right Middle	4 Right Ring	5 Right Little
				

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF LEFT HAND

6 Left Thumb	7 Left Fore	8 Left Middle	9 Left Ring	10 Left Little
				

PLAIN IMPRESSION OF BOTH HANDS

LEFT HAND Four fingers taken together	TWO THUMBS Taken together LEFT RIGHT	RIGHT HAND Four fingers taken together
		

Part 4 cont'd

GEORGE THOMAS
Right Hand



Left Hand



ELIMINATION FINGERPRINT FORM

This form must be completed in BLOCK LETTERS using black ink.

Palm prints should be taken overleaf.

TO BE USED FOR TAKING PRINTS OF VICTIMS OF CRIME, SUSPECTS AND THOSE WITH LEGITIMATE ACCESS TO A CRIME SCENE.

Name MICHAEL LAWSON Taken by MATTHEWS
 Address 12 NERINE DRIVE, SMITHTON Rank D.I.
 Offence KIDNAP Date 18.6.10
 Location 12 NERINE DRIVE, SMITHTON Crime Reference Number 921176

These prints will be destroyed after the necessary comparisons have been made unless the donor has been found guilty of the crime.

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF RIGHT HAND

1 Right Thumb	2 Right Fore	3 Right Middle	4 Right Ring	5 Right Little
				

ROLLED IMPRESSION OF LEFT HAND

6 Left Thumb	7 Left Fore	8 Left Middle	9 Left Ring	10 Left Little
				

PLAIN IMPRESSION OF BOTH HANDS

LEFT HAND Four fingers taken together	TWO THUMBS Taken together LEFT RIGHT	RIGHT HAND Four fingers taken together
		

Part 4 cont'd

MICHAEL LAWSON

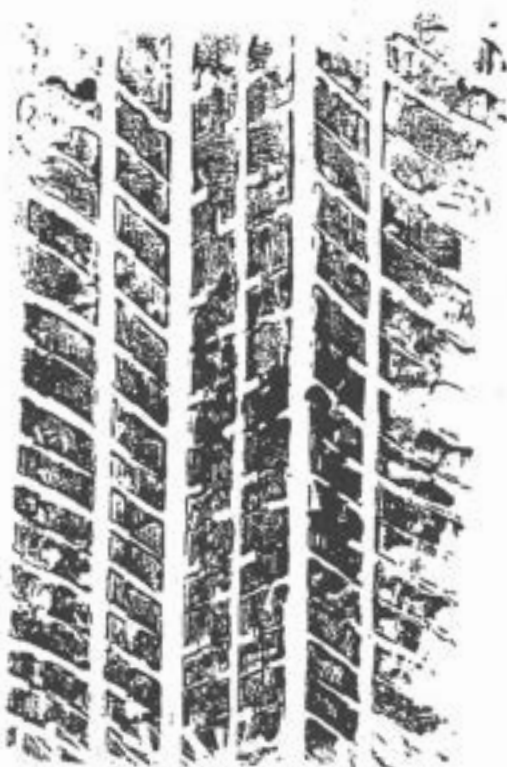
Right Hand



Left Hand



Suspects' car tyre prints



Alice Lawson



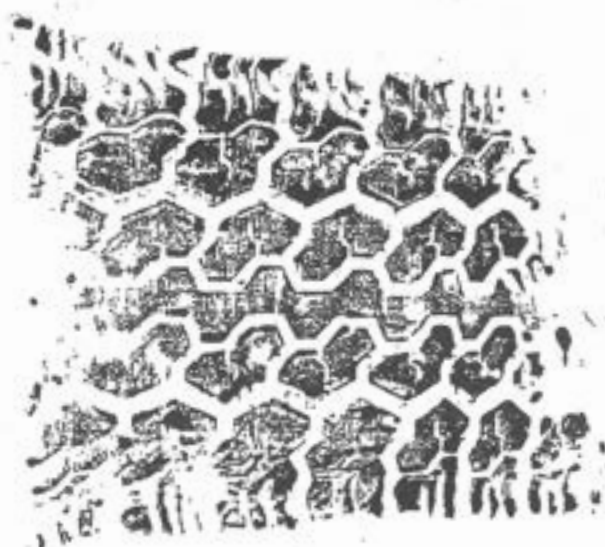
Betty Thomas



Frank Furletti



Michael Lawson



Andrew Phillips

Suspects' sports shoe prints



Michael Lawson (size 11)



Brad Lawson (size 12)



Andrew Phillips (size 11)



Frank Furletti (size 11.5)



George Thomas (size 11)

Suspects' handwriting samples

Remove the fat from the
and pour over the pref
vegetables.

Betty Thomas

A number of French
formed a high-
in March 2003 to
and priorities for
new energy techn
recommendations

Andrew Phillips

I still haven't been
any work. At my age
any labouring and if
desk jobs they say
I don't know why.

George Thomas

In reference to your
send you and email
it will outline our
future construction
for manager of our

Michael Lawson

In his report on
that it is more widespread
originally thought. It
is growing as we,
even further providing
grounds than previous

Alice Lawson

Bring a large
water to the bo
groceries to the
they came to the
and loss into

Jennifer Phillips

It was a great
was up and the
You have never
it. The locals
as the best

Brad Lawson

Re: Plumbing Work

Elec. Eel	\$35.00
Parts	\$12.50
Labour	\$60.00
1.00 hrs @ \$60.00	

Total	<u>\$177.50</u>
-------	-----------------

with thanks.

Frank Furletti

FFurletti

Name _____

Analysis of suspects' fingerprints

Inspect the full sets of elimination fingerprints. Use the following codes for the basic patterns in the prints:

A = arch L = loop W = whorl C = composite U = unknown

There are also codes for more complex patterns:

UL = ulna loop (where the loop slopes down towards the little finger) TA = tented arch

RL = radial loop (where the loop slopes down towards the thumb) DL = double loop

CPL = central pocket loop

- 1** For each suspect, identify the shape of the pattern on each of their 10 fingers and record these in the table below. Record any scars with the letter 'S'.

Suspect	Left hand					Right hand				
	little finger	ring finger	middle finger	fore-finger	thumb	thumb	fore-finger	middle finger	ring finger	little finger
Alice Lawson										
	Any other comments regarding palms, fingers or size of hands									
Betty Thomas										
	Any other comments regarding palms, fingers or size of hands									
Brad Lawson										
	Any other comments regarding palms, fingers or size of hands									
Frank Furletti										
	Any other comments regarding palms, fingers or size of hands									
George Thomas										
	Any other comments regarding palms, fingers or size of hands									
Michael Lawson										
	Any other comments regarding palms, fingers or size of hands									

- 2** Look at the fingerprints found at the crime scene. Record the patterns on each fingerprint in the table below. If the fingerprint is not present or its pattern is not clear, write 'X' in the space. Then identify any similarities between the fingerprints found at the crime scene and the suspects' fingerprints.

Prints	Left hand					Right hand				
	little finger	ring finger	middle finger	fore-finger	thumb	thumb	fore-finger	middle finger	ring finger	little finger
Set A on the cot										
	Any other comments regarding palms, fingers or size of hands									
Set B on the cot										
	Any other comments regarding palms, fingers or size of hands									
Bedroom shelf										
	Any other comments regarding palms, fingers or size of hands									
Dining room window										
	Any other comments regarding palms, fingers or size of hands									

Name _____

- 3 Compare the evidence taken from the suspects in Part 4 (fingerprints, car tyre prints, shoe prints, handwriting) with the evidence found at the crime scene in Part 2 (including the evidence bags A–G). In the table below record any evidence that can be linked to a suspect and a reasonable explanation for the presence of that evidence. The first one has been started for you. (If you need more space, use the back of this sheet.)

Suspect	Evidence that links this person with the crime scene
Alice Lawson	<i>Fingerprints found on the cot – expected, as she puts Jamie to bed</i>
Betty Thomas	
Frank Furletti	
Jennifer Phillips	
Brad Lawson	
Michael Lawson	
George Thomas	

- 4 List your three prime suspects in order from most likely to least likely. For each person, say why you think he or she may be the kidnapper. (If you need more space, use the back of this sheet.)

Prime suspect	Reason
1	
2	
3	

Late afternoon on 18 June 2010

Michael Lawson arrived home around 5pm. At about the same time, a retired couple were walking their dog on a beach about 3 kilometres from the Lawson's home and found Jamie Lawson wandering on the sand dunes.

Jamie was still wearing his pale blue pyjamas. He was grubby and crying for his mother, but physically unharmed. Michael Lawson had not been home for long when he took the phone call from the police saying they had found Jamie. He and Alice left immediately for the police station where they were reunited with their son.

The police made enquiries of people near the place where Jamie was found. This produced only one item of evidence that could help. A young man jogging on the beach saw an old white Ford or Holden driving out from the same dunes at a very fast speed at about 4 o'clock. He didn't remember the driver clearly except that he was wearing a beanie and 'Didn't appear to be a teenage lout, like you sometimes saw being a nuisance in the sand dunes.'

Summary of interview with Jamie Lawson

James Michael Lawson is two-and-a-half years old and he was interviewed while sitting on his mother's lap. His father was also present. Jamie is the only son of Michael Trevor Lawson and his wife Alice Louise Lawson. They reside at 12 Nerine Drive, Smithton.

The following information was extracted from the child after gentle and sympathetic questioning by Police Constable Margaret Johns and his mother.

- Jamie was held in an upstairs flat, probably the kidnapper's own home.
- Jamie did not know the man.
- He played with the man's cat but did not know what colour it was.
- The man was wearing a fuzzy, hairy jumper.
- The man smelt smoky.
- There were no other people in the house only the cat.
- Jamie had no idea how he got to the man's house, he only remembered waking up there.
- Jamie said that he went to the beach to find Mummy, because the man had said that she would be there.
- Jamie said they went in a big, dirty car. When shown some colours, he indicated that the car was white or a pale cream.

Latest information from the forensic laboratory

- The tea left in the cup by the television where Mrs Lawson had sat the evening Jamie disappeared contained remnants of a sleeping pill. Mrs Lawson claims never to have used sleeping pills and certainly not on 17 June.
- The hair fibres found on the cot blanket were consistent with cat hair and were all white.

POLICE CONSTABULARY
STATEMENT OF WITNESS



Statement of (name of witness) MICHAEL LAWSON

Taken by D. I. BROWN Date 18.6.10 Time 5.30pm

Q Mr Lawson, could you give your full name, age, address, spouse's name and relationship to the missing boy for the benefit of the tape please.

My name is Michael Trevor Lawson. I live at 12 Nerine Drive, Smithton. I am 32 years of age, and am married to Alice Louise Lawson. We have one son, James Michael Lawson, aged two and a half years.

Q Thank you Mr Lawson. Now can you tell me when you first heard about the lottery win yesterday?

Yes. I received a message after my meeting, to ring my wife urgently. I rang about 5.15pm when I got back to my motel. She told me the news then.

Q And what was your reaction to this news?

Well at first I was a bit overcome. I suppose I was excited but it didn't really hit me, the significance of it, 'til later. I did ask Alice not to tell anyone, not even family, until I got home and we could discuss it.

Q Did your wife indicate that she had already told some people?

Yes, she told me that Betty had overheard her phone conversation and that she had asked her not to discuss it with anyone else. Also, that she had told Jenny Phillips.

Q Mr Lawson, when did you first hear of Jamie's disappearance?

At about 8.30am this morning when my wife rang me.

Q And what did you do then?

I tried to reassure Alice and promised her I would come home on the first flight available.

Q Mr Lawson, are you a smoker?

No, I haven't smoked since my early teenage years.

D.I. Thank you Mr Lawson, that will be all for now. I am very pleased that you have your son back.

This statement of 1 pages signed by me is the truth to the best of my knowledge.

Dated the 18th day of June 20 10 Signed M Lawson

POLICE CONSTABULARY
STATEMENT OF WITNESSStatement of (name of witness) GEORGE THOMASTaken by D. I. BROWN Date 18.6.10 Time 4.15pm

Q Mr Thomas, could you give your full name, age, address, spouse's name, occupation and relationship to the Lawsons for the benefit of the tape please.

My name is George Thomas. I live in Unit 15, 238 Foster Rd, Smithton. I am 52 years of age and am married to Betty Thomas. At present I am unemployed and I last worked as a security guard.

Q Thank you Mr Thomas. I have just a few questions to ask. When did you last see Jamie Lawson?

I am not sure I have seen him in the last year. I may have seen him when picking the wife up from work, but I'm not sure. I only pick her up occasionally. Usually she takes the car. Yesterday was one of those days. Betty finished late, after dark, so I picked her up to take her over to her sister's place for the weekend.

Q Do you ever go into the house when you pick up your wife?

No. I usually just toot and she comes out.

Q And you picked up your wife from work last night?

Yes. I picked her up at 8 o'clock like we arranged, then I drove her over to her sister's house in Lockton. I went back home and watched TV.

Q So no one can confirm where you were after 9pm last night?

Oh yes. I rang my brother after I got home, about quarter to ten. So you could check the phone records that I was home then.

Q Right, we'll do that. Now when exactly did you find out about the lottery money?

I didn't hear about it until I heard the news this morning.

Q Your wife didn't discuss it with you yesterday when you picked her up, or over the phone?

No, I don't think she did. I don't really remember what we talked about. I don't think she mentioned it then, maybe she told me at 8 o'clock when I picked her up.

Q So your wife's employer winning \$1 million is not important enough to mention in a phone call?

No, not really; we don't mix in the same social group. They keep to theirs and we keep to ours. That's their business. Anyway, Betty says Mrs Lawson told her not to tell anyone, so she didn't.

Q Your wife has told us that you own some pets, Mr Thomas, is that right?

Yes. We have a Fox terrier, Bert, and Molly the cat.

Q And Molly is ginger and white?

Yes, that's right.

Q And Mr Thomas, are you a smoker?

No, I gave up smoking years ago. The wife said it cost too much and it made me stink. Still, I think the open fire she expects me to light every day makes the house stink just as much.

D.I. Thank you for your help Mr Thomas, we'll be in touch.

This statement of 1 pages signed by me is the truth to the best of my knowledge.

Dated the 18th day of June 20 10 Signed g Thomas

Name _____

Solving the crime

- 1** Use the information in 'Further developments' (page 42) and the final two statements to answer the following questions.

a When and how do you think the kidnapper planned the crime?

b How may the kidnapper have entered the house?

c Why didn't Alice Lawson hear Jamie being kidnapped?

d When and how was the ransom note written and placed on the shelf?

e Why didn't Jamie recognise his kidnapper?

f What time do you think the kidnapper took Jamie? Give reasons for your answer.

g How was Jamie transported from his home to the kidnapper's house?

h Why do you think Jamie was released at the beach?

Part 5 cont'd



Name _____

2 Imagine that you are the prosecution lawyer at the trial of the kidnapper of Jamie Lawson. Explain to the jury how you think the crime was carried out. Describe the motive and mention anyone else you think was involved and how they contributed to the crime. Remember, you have to be clear and concise and convince the jury, beyond all reasonable doubt, that this person is the kidnapper.

Lined area for student response.

Activity 1

- 1 CSEs wear overalls, gloves, hair nets and overshoes so they leave no trace of themselves behind. They use tweezers and duckboards so no evidence is destroyed.
- 2 Type of object, where found, date, person who collected the item. So it can be tracked and not come into the possession of any unauthorised person.
- 3 Forensic dentist – skeleton; fingerprint expert – fingerprints; handwriting expert – handwritten note; pathologist or DNA expert – spots of blood or saliva; chemist or pharmacist – drugs; ballistics expert – bullets, gun or used cartridge cases.
- 4 B Go straight to a neighbour's house to ring your family and the police; to keep safe, inform your family about what has happened and begin crime investigation procedures.

Activity 2

- 2 Square shaped fingerprint made using ink, round partial print found at crime scene.
- 3 C

Activity 3

- 1 Different people because M, J, D, T, r, f and t different. Also different slope, spaces and loops below the line.
- 2 Family should dispute the will. Many shapes are the same at first glance but the spacing, slope and loops below the line are different, which suggests different writers.

Part 1

- 1 Call the police, then call her husband. She should not touch anything.
- 2 The police are the experts in catching criminals; her husband has a right to know what has happened to his child and can give Alice support. Touching things might destroy or contaminate vital evidence.
- 3 Crime scene examiners: search house and garden for evidence left by kidnapper. Psychological profiler: to work out why Jamie was taken and suggest where to look for him. Police draughtsman: to draw a map of the crime scene showing where evidence was found. Police photographer: to photograph the scene before anything is moved.
- 4 C, E
- 5 A handwriting expert and a fingerprint expert.
- 6 Handwriting and fingerprint comparison.
- 7 Fingerprints; hairs and fibres; footprints; signs of break-in (broken glass or forced windows and doors); anything that is out of place or looks odd.
- 8 These could include: What were your movements during the previous day? Did you notice anything unusual or suspicious? Who knew about the lottery win? When did you last see Jamie and what was he wearing? How is your relationship with Jamie's father? Do you know anyone who might bear the family a grudge?
- 9 Question Jamie's mother; ask neighbours if they have seen anything suspicious.

Part 2

- 1 **b** Tyre marks photographed with side lighting, cast made with plaster of Paris; compared with tyreprints of suspects' cars.
c Footprints photographed with side lighting, a cast made with plaster of Paris; compared with shoe prints made with suspects' shoes.
d Butt picked up with tweezers and packed in a sealed, labelled bag; DNA analysis, brand compared to any from suspects.
e Cup handled with gloves; contents placed in a sealed container; cup tested for fingerprints and DNA; contents tested for drugs.
f Fibres picked up with tweezers and packed in a sealed, labelled bag; tested for fibre type and compared to clothes from suspects.
g Hairs picked up with tweezers and packed in a sealed, labelled bag; type of animal identified by microscope inspection.
h Tool marks photographed and a cast made from silicone rubber material; compared to any tools found belonging to suspects.
i Note picked up with tweezers and packed in a sealed, labelled bag; tested for fingerprints, handwriting compared to suspects' handwriting.
- 2 **Alice Lawson:** zero; child is her own, she discovered him missing.
Michael Lawson: low; the child is his, he was interstate when the kidnapping occurred, there does not appear to be any family conflict, no point in robbing himself.
Betty Thomas: high; knows about lottery win, has access to house and key, knows the family's habits; money may be a motive.
Frank Furletti: high; knows about lottery win, needs money so this may be a motive.
Jenny Phillips: low; she is a friend and has children of her own, no known motive
Brad Lawson: high; has a motive, needs money, knows about the lottery win, is a black sheep, but is family.
- 3 What were your movements during the previous day? Did you know about the Lawson's lottery win? What was your reaction to the lottery win and to Jamie's disappearance? How well do you know Jamie? What is your relationship with the Lawson family? Do you own any pets? If so, what type/colour? Do you smoke? If so, what brand? What type of shoes were you wearing at the time? What type of jumper were you wearing?

Part 3

- 1 Alice Lawson: none; she is the mother and was upset, she discovered Jamie was missing.
Betty Thomas: knew about the lottery win, told husband, needs money, has access to house, made the cup of tea; but is a trusted employee.
Frank Furletti: knew about the lottery win, needs money, knows the layout of the house, may know where the key was kept; but is a trusted tradesman and was at the house before Jamie went missing.
Jennifer Phillips: knew about the lottery win; is a trusted friend.
Brad Lawson: knew about the lottery win, needs money, probably knew the layout of the house, but is a family member.
- 2 George Thomas: because we need to know his version of what Betty, his wife, said. What were your movements from about 7pm last night until this morning? When did you hear about the lottery win? How do you feel about it? When did you last see Jamie? How well do you know him? Do you ever enter the Lawson's house?
Michael Lawson: to see what he has to say about Jamie's disappearance. What were your movements from about 7pm last night until this morning? When did you hear about the lottery win? How do you feel about it? When did you first hear that Jamie was missing? What was your reaction? What is your relationship with your wife like? Your brother has been described as the black sheep of the family, what are your views of this? Would your brother be capable of kidnapping Jamie? Do you know of anyone who bears you or your family a grudge?

Part 4

- 1

Alice Lawson	UL	UL	W	W	UL	UL	W	UL	UL	UL
Betty Thomas	UL	UL	A	C	UL	UL	A	A	UL	UL
	Lots of cracks in grid pattern over whole hands									
Brad Lawson	UL	UL	TA	TA	UL	A	A	UL	UL	worn
Frank Furletti	CPL	W	W	RL	CPL	W	W	UL	W	UL
George Thomas	UL	UL	UL	RL	DL	W	RL	UL	UL	UL
Michael Lawson	UL	A(S)	A	A	C	W	CPL	UL	UL	UL
	Vertical scar on left ring finger									
- 2

Set 1 on cot	X	UL	W	W	X	X	X	X	X	X
	No other prints have UL, W, W on left hand, so fingerprints match Alice Lawson.									
Set 2 on cot	X	UL	UL	RL	DL	X	X	X	X	X
	Double loop on thumb and radial loop on LH forefinger match George Thomas.									
On shelf	The patterns and especially the many fine cracks match the fingerprints of Betty Lawson.									
Dining window	The patterns and vertical scar on the left finger match the fingerprints of Michael Lawson.									
- 3 Alice Lawson: her fingerprints on the cot are expected because she puts Jamie to bed; her tyreprints in driveway are expected because she lives there.
Betty Thomas: her fingerprints on shelf may occur when dusting; her handwriting on note is suspicious, the white fur may be from her cat (unconfirmed); tyreprints in driveway expected because she works there.
Frank Furletti: no suspicious evidence only motive, Jamie may have picked up cigarette butt; tyreprints on side road left there when he stopped to write invoice.
Jennifer Phillips: no evidence or motive; she suggested Jamie picked up objects like stones and cigarette butts.
Brad Lawson: no evidence, but needs money – possible motive.
Michael Lawson: his footprints outside and fingerprints on the dining room window indicate he may have broken into his own house, however Betty explained he forgot his key when he went running.
George Thomas: his fingerprints and green fibres on the cot indicate he is the most likely kidnapper.
- 4 George Thomas: fibres and fingerprints on cot.
Betty Thomas: handwriting on ransom note.
Brad Lawson or Frank Furletti: both had motives and knew about money, but no other evidence.

Part 5

- 1
 - a George and Betty planned the crime over the phone when Alice was talking to Brad Lawson.
 - b Betty had a key which she gave to George when he collected her at 8pm.
 - c Alice was asleep after being drugged with a sleeping tablet in her cup of tea.
 - d Betty wrote the ransom note and gave it to George who left it on the shelf when he took Jamie.
 - e Jamie did not know George, only Betty who was at her sister's house.
 - f Jamie was taken between 9 and 9.45pm, as George phoned his brother at 9.45 when he arrived home.
 - g In the Thomas' car after George had taken Betty to Lockton.
 - h The police investigation made George realise the seriousness of what he had done, and he lost his nerve.
- 2 George Thomas was the kidnapper, helped by his wife Betty. George was unemployed and Betty only had a small income, so their motive was lack of money. They planned the crime together over the phone. Betty wrote the note and put a sleeping drug in Alice's cup of tea. George picked Betty up from work at 8pm and took her to her sister's house. He returned to the Lawson's house about 9pm and entered using Betty's key. George left the ransom note on the shelf and kidnapped Jamie, leaving his fingerprints and jumper fibres on the cot and some cat hair on a cot blanket. He took Jamie back to his flat. The next day, with the police questioning his wife, he lost his nerve and left Jamie at the beach before giving his own statement to police.

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